Was or Were?

Activity Type

Grammar Exercises: gap-fill, binary choice, rewriting sentences

Focus

'Was' and 'were'

Aim

To practice using 'was' and 'were' in simple sentences about people, places and times in the past.

Preparation

Make one copy of the worksheet for each student.

Level

Elementary (A1-A2)

Time

20 minutes

Introduction

In this was and were worksheet, students practice the past simple of 'be' by completing a gap-fill, choosing the correct form, and rewriting present-tense sentences in the past.

Procedure

Give each student a copy of the worksheet.

Students begin by completing sentences with was or were.

Exercise A - Answer key

1. was
2. was
3. was
4. were
5. was
6. were
7. were
8. was
9. were
10. were
11. was
12. were

Students then complete sentences by choosing was or were.

Exercise B - Answer key

1. was
2. was
3. were
4. was
5. were
6. was
7. were
8. were
9. was
10. was
11. was
12. was

Next, students rewrite sentences changing 'am', 'is', 'are' into the past simple (was, were).

Exercise C - Answer key

1. She was a good student.
2. Bella and Claire were on holiday.
3. I was in the supermarket.
4. The pencils were on the desk.
5. They were late for class.
6. Tom and Sam were my friends.
7. The English test was hard.
8. The dogs were in the garden.
9. The food was very good.
10. You were in the kitchen.
11. The cat was in the tree.
12. The hotel room was small.
13. I was on the bus.
14. My parents were at work.

Finally, check the correct answers with the class and review how to use was and were.

Note: This resource can be edited using a PDF editor.

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Was or Were?

A. Fill in the gaps with 'was' or 'were'.

1. He ..... very happy.
2. Elle ..... at the park yesterday.
3. ..... the test difficult?
4. Where ..... you yesterday?
5. It ..... raining yesterday.
6. My children ..... in Spain a year ago.
7. You ..... at school until 3 p.m.
8. She ..... in Madrid last summer.
9. They ..... at the beach yesterday.
10. Adam and Rose ..... best friends.
11. The cat ..... in the tree.
12. We ..... tired.

B. Choose the correct answer.

1. The weather *was* / *were* very cold yesterday.
2. The teacher *was* / *were* angry yesterday.
3. My friends *was* / *were* hungry.
4. Jessica *was* / *were* at home last night.
5. We *was* / *were* at school yesterday.
6. He *was* / *were* sick last week.
7. The children *was* / *were* tired after class.
8. My friends *was* / *were* at the beach all day.
9. It *was* / *were* a very hot day.
10. *Was* / *Were* Henry at the party?
11. My son *was* / *were* born in July.
12. I *was* / *were* 19 years old last year.



C. Rewrite the sentences changing 'am', 'is', 'are' into the past simple (was, were).

1. She is a good student. .....
2. Bella and Claire are on holiday. .....
3. I am in the supermarket. .....
4. The pencils are on the desk. .....
5. They are late for class. .....
6. Tom and Sam are my friends. .....
7. The English test is hard. .....
8. The dogs are in the garden. .....
9. The food is very good. .....
10. You are in the kitchen. .....
11. The cat is in the tree. .....
12. The hotel room is small. .....
13. I am on the bus. .....
14. My parents are at work. .....

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